

Cloudera and StreamNative develop an open source connector

Cloudera and StreamNative have made an open source connector that integrates Apache NiFi and Apache Pulsar. The connector will be included with the Cloudera platform. NiFi and Pulsar can be combined to create a cloud-native streaming data platform capable of ingesting, transforming, and analysing massive amounts of data.



Cloudera's team includes some of the original Apache NiFi developers, whereas StreamNative was founded by the original Apache Pulsar creators. NiFi was created from the NSA's 'Niagara Files' technology and made available to the Apache Software Foundation via the NSA Technology Transfer Program. NiFi is a flow-based programming visual tool that can be used to create data flows that move data from one technological platform to another, such as databases, cloud storage, and messaging systems.

NiFi provides data provenance and traceability at the event level. The NiFi platform comes with over 100 pre-built processors. Apache Pulsar is a cloud-native, distributed messaging and streaming platform that was developed at Yahoo! and is now an Apache Software Foundation top-level project. To provide long-term stream storage, Pulsar employs a replicated distributed ledger.

Red Hat Survey: Businesses are more likely to opt for open source vendors

According to Red Hat's recent State of Enterprise Open Source Survey, 82 per cent of decision makers are more likely to choose an open source vendor.

The top reasons for this are that they are experienced with open source methods and help maintain healthy communities (both indicated by 49 per cent of respondents), can influence feature development (48 per cent), and are more likely to be effective in the face of technical obstacles (46 per cent).

During the pandemic, open source development has got a boost, and 95 per cent of the more than 1,200 IT executives polled said it's important to their enterprise infrastructure strategy and is steadily replacing proprietary software as a source of innovation.

Enterprise Open Source (EOS) now represents 29 per cent of all workloads. In two years, this figure is expected to climb to 34 per cent, while proprietary software will decline from 45 per cent to 37 per cent.

According to the survey, 77 per cent of respondents now have a more favourable opinion of enterprise open source than they did a year ago. Furthermore, 55 per cent of respondents cite the ability to use well-tested code for in-house applications as the primary reason for choosing open source.

Google's Jigsaw unit releases Harassment Manager for journalists

Google's Jigsaw unit is providing the source code for Harassment Manager, an open source anti-harassment tool. The application, which is aimed at journalists and other prominent figures, uses Jigsaw's Perspective API to allow users to sort through potentially harmful remarks on social media networks like Twitter. In June this year, it will be released as source code for developers to build on, followed by a functional application for Thomson Reuters Foundation journalists.

Harassment Manager can use Twitter's API to combine moderating features such as concealing tweet replies and muting or blocking users with a bulk filtering and reporting mechanism. Threats, insults, and profanity are among the elements used by Perspective to assess the "toxicity" of messages. It organises messages into queues on a dashboard, allowing users to respond to them in bulk rather than individually using Twitter's usual moderating tools. They can opt to blur the text of



the messages so they don't have to read each one individually, and they can search for keywords in addition to using the automatically generated queues.

On International Women's Day, Jigsaw released Harassment Manager, emphasising that the tool is especially relevant to female journalists who endure gender based abuse, "journalists and activists with large Twitter presences," as well as non-profits like the International Women's Media Foundation and the Committee To Protect Journalists. "Our hope is that this technology provides a resource for people who are facing harassment online, especially female journalists, activists, politicians and other public figures, who deal with disproportionately high toxicity online," the Jigsaw team posted.

Harassment Manager, unlike AI-powered moderation on platforms like Twitter and Instagram, is not a platform-side moderation feature. It is a sorting tool for dealing with the sometimes overwhelming volume of social media comments, and could be useful even for individuals who are not journalists.